

Arizona State Favored By WAC Baseball Coaches

TUCSON, Ariz. (AP)—They're picking Arizona State, the school that won two national championships, to win the Western Athletic Conference baseball race in 1969.

In a poll of WAC coaches conducted by the Arizona Daily Star, the Sun Devils of ASU received five of the possible eight votes for first place. The other three went to the University of Arizona which last year won the Southern Division and then lost to Brigham Young for the WAC championship.

Arizona State, 10-1

So highly rated are the Sun Devils by WAC coaches that they received no votes lower than second place. And the Devils have shown their strength by winning 10 of their opening 11 games.

Arizona, undefeated in six games so far, was a solid choice for second place, with BYU, the defending champion, picked to finish third. Following were New Mexico, Wyoming, Utah and then the two new additions to the WAC, Colorado State University and Texas-El Paso.

CSU Rated Seventh

Here is the way coaches voted

in the Star's baseball poll (first place votes in parentheses and points totaled on basis of 10 for first place and then 7-6-5-4-3-2-1):

1. Arizona State (5).....71
2. Arizona (3)63
3. Brigham Young48
4. New Mexico37
5. Wyoming32
6. University of Utah.....25
7. Colorado State15
8. Texas at El Paso.....13

Bobby Winkles, the coach who guided Arizona State to a pair of national championships in the College World Series, says he has a good ball club.

"We've got players switched around at every position," he says, "but I think we have the best outfield in all college baseball. Our pitching looks good, but we're awfully thin at catching. The pros took Ron Davini and that left us Bill Cotton."

Wildcat Coach Happy

Coach Frank Sancet is pleased with the start of his Wildcats.

"We've been winning, but I don't know how tough our opponents really have been," Sancet remarked. "We could be a real good hitting ball club."

Glenn Tuckett, coach of the defending champion BYU Cou-

gars, said, "I think we will be pretty tough. We've got good pitching — the same almost as last season when we won the title—but we have a new double play combination. And we may have lost our best hitter, Larry Romney, for the season."

Romney, who hit 13 home runs last season, broke his left hand while wrestling playfully with his dormitory roommate. He's had the hand in a cast for three weeks.

Snow and cold weather have limited all the northern clubs this season.

New Mexico Coach Bob Lee has his Lobos off to a 3-0 start.

"But we've had a couple of injuries that could be a real problem," he declares. "We don't have our two big pitching stoppers of last year, but we do have a good pitching depth."

Bud Daniel, the Wyoming coach, chuckles when he's asked to talk baseball.

Northern Teams Tough

"Baseball," he laughs, "It was 15 below last night and it's even been too cold to work indoors. I'll tell you this — the Northern Division is going to be the toughest it's ever been. We'll have good pitching and strong defense. The question will be whether we hit."

Pres Summerhays of Utah says his Redskins "are capable of winning in the division."

"We have a good ball club and I think we'll be as strong as anyone in the north," he said.

Colorado State's Irv Ferguson figures his club "will be respectable. We have a senior outfield and all our pitchers are back."

But CSU and Texas-El Paso will be competing in the WAC for the first time. Colorado State competes in the Northern Division and the Texans are in the Southern with the Arizona clubs and New Mexico.

"We've won our last six games," says former major leaguer Andy Cohen, who coaches Texas-El Paso baseball. "So far pitching has been our strong point. We've got to tighten our infield if we are going to do anything in the WAC."

Love P As Na

DENVER — The week of st
March 16-22 has been designat-

Gagelak Studios